M57 Report
Case: nps_E01 (Autopsy 4.23.1)
Evidence: nps-2008-jean.E01, Jean's hard drive (10 GB, MD5 78a52b5bac78f4e711607707ac0e3f93)
Date: 10/23/2026

Scenario and Context

M57.biz is a virtual start-up developing a body art catalog. It has $3M in seed funding and is closing a $10M round. It has two founders and ten employees hired in the first year: President Alison Smith, CFO Jean, programmers Bob, Carole, David and Emmy, marketing staff Gina and Harris, and business developer Indy. Staff work remotely, and most documents are exchanged by email.

A spreadsheet containing confidential information (names, positions, salaries and Social Security numbers of all staff) was posted as an attachment in the "technical support" forum of a competitor's website. The spreadsheet came from CFO Jean's computer.
In interviews, Alison said she never asked Jean for the spreadsheet and never received it by email. Jean said Alison asked her to prepare the spreadsheet for the new funding round and to email it to her.

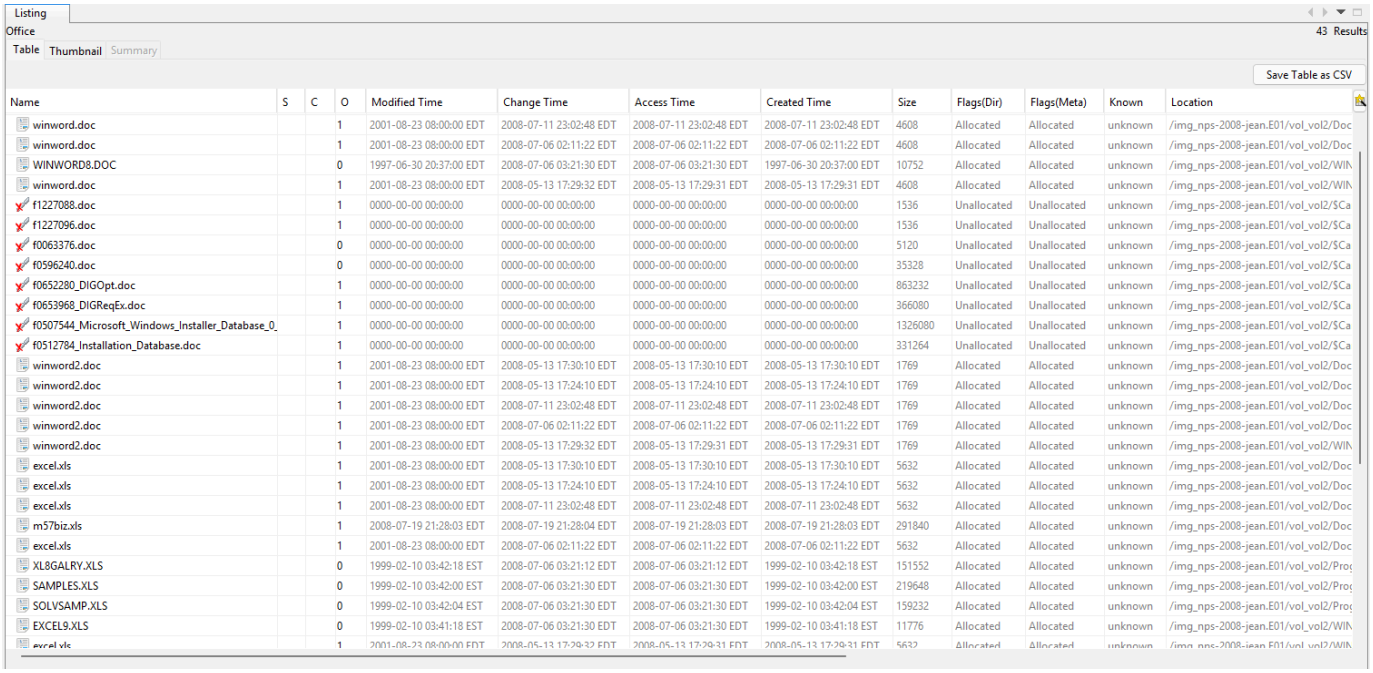
A first-round funder asked three questions: when Jean created the spreadsheet, how it got from her computer to the competitor's website, and who else from the company is involved. This report answers them from a forensic image of Jean's computer, examined in Autopsy.

Summary

• The spreadsheet on Jean's computer is m57biz.xls. Jean last saved it at 2008-07-20 01:28:03 UTC (2008-07-19 21:28:03 EDT). Its internal metadata shows it was originally created on 2008-06-12.
• Jean emailed it, one minute before her final save, to an attacker impersonating Alison, using the address tuckgorge@gmail.com. The attacker confirmed receipt in a follow-up email.
• The request that Jean answered was spoofed. Alison does not appear to be involved. One account, alex@m57.biz, remains unexplained.
• The image shows no evidence of the final step, the upload to the competitor's forum.

1. When did Jean create this spreadsheet?

a. The spreadsheet was made on 2008-06-12 15:13:51, and it was modified on 2008-07-20 01:28:03
b. It was found under File Views > File Types > By Extension > Documents >Office
c. From there, m57biz.xls can be found.



Listing

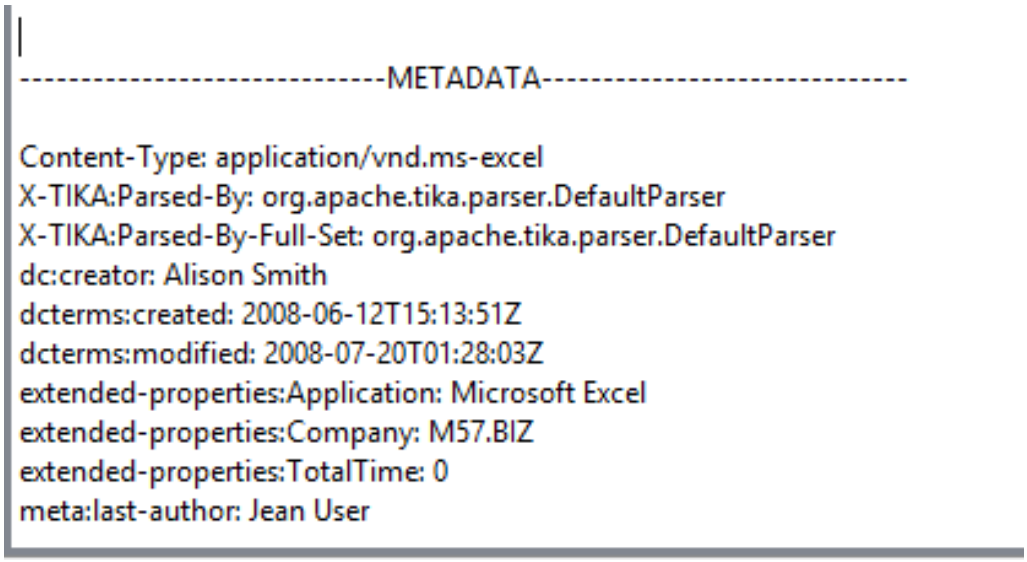
Office

43 Results

Table | Thumbnail | Summary

Save Table as CSV

Name	S	C	O	Modified Time	Change Time	Access Time	Created Time	Size	Flags(Dir)	Flags(Meta)	Known	Location
winword.doc			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	4608	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
winword.doc			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	4608	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
WINWORD8.DOC			0	1997-06-30 20:37:00 EDT	2008-07-06 03:21:30 EDT	2008-07-06 03:21:30 EDT	1997-06-30 20:37:00 EDT	10752	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/WIN
winword.doc			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:32 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:31 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:31 EDT	4608	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/WIN
f1227088.doc			1	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	1536	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/$Ca
f1227096.doc			1	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	1536	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/$Ca
f0063376.doc			0	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	5120	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/$Ca
f0596240.doc			0	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	35328	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/$Ca
f0652280_DIGOpt.doc			1	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	863232	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/$Ca
f0653968_DIGReqEx.doc			1	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	366080	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/$Ca
f0507544_Microsoft_Windows_Installer_Database_0_			1	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	1326080	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/$Ca
f0512784_Installation_Database.doc			1	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-00 00:00:00	331264	Unallocated	Unallocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/$Ca
winword2.doc			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-05-13 17:30:10 EDT	2008-05-13 17:30:10 EDT	2008-05-13 17:30:10 EDT	1769	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
winword2.doc			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-05-13 17:24:10 EDT	2008-05-13 17:24:10 EDT	2008-05-13 17:24:10 EDT	1769	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
winword2.doc			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	1769	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
winword2.doc			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	1769	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
winword2.doc			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:32 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:31 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:31 EDT	1769	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/WIN
excel.xls			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-05-13 17:30:10 EDT	2008-05-13 17:30:10 EDT	2008-05-13 17:30:10 EDT	5632	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
excel.xls			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-05-13 17:24:10 EDT	2008-05-13 17:24:10 EDT	2008-05-13 17:24:10 EDT	5632	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
excel.xls			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	2008-07-11 23:02:48 EDT	5632	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
m57biz.xls			1	2008-07-19 21:28:03 EDT	2008-07-19 21:28:04 EDT	2008-07-19 21:28:03 EDT	2008-07-19 21:28:03 EDT	291840	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
excel.xls			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	2008-07-06 02:11:22 EDT	5632	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Doc
XL8GALRY.XLS			0	1999-02-10 03:42:18 EST	2008-07-06 03:21:12 EDT	2008-07-06 03:21:12 EDT	1999-02-10 03:42:18 EST	151552	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Pro
SAMPLES.XLS			0	1999-02-10 03:42:00 EST	2008-07-06 03:21:30 EDT	2008-07-06 03:21:30 EDT	1999-02-10 03:42:00 EST	219648	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Pro
SOLVSAMP.XLS			0	1999-02-10 03:42:04 EST	2008-07-06 03:21:30 EDT	2008-07-06 03:21:30 EDT	1999-02-10 03:42:04 EST	159232	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/Pro
EXCEL9.XLS			0	1999-02-10 03:41:18 EST	2008-07-06 03:21:30 EDT	2008-07-06 03:21:30 EDT	1999-02-10 03:41:18 EST	11776	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/WIN
excel.xls			1	2001-08-23 08:00:00 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:32 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:31 EDT	2008-05-13 17:29:31 EDT	5632	Allocated	Allocated	unknown	/img_nps-2008-jean.E01/vol_vol2/WIN

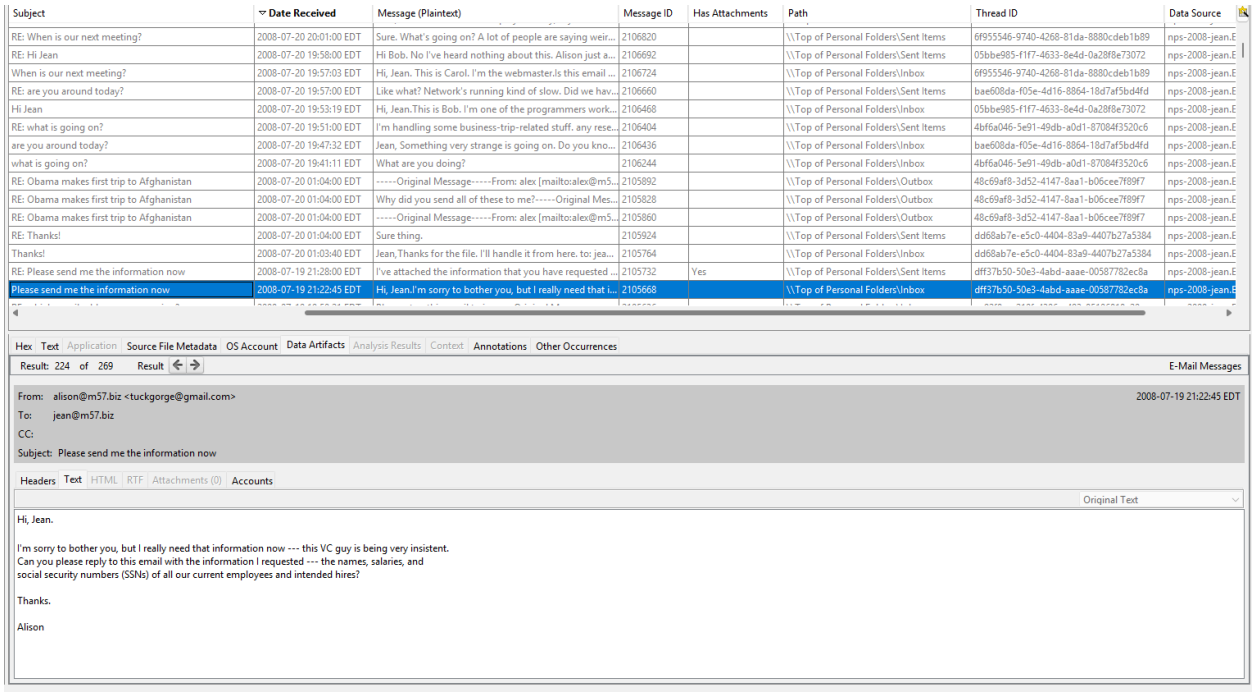


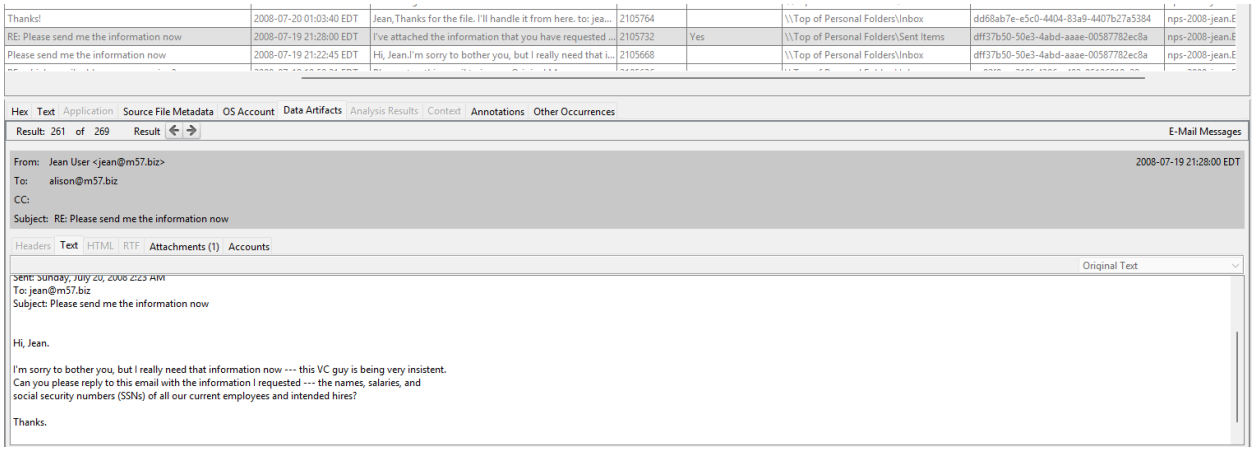
----------METADATA----------

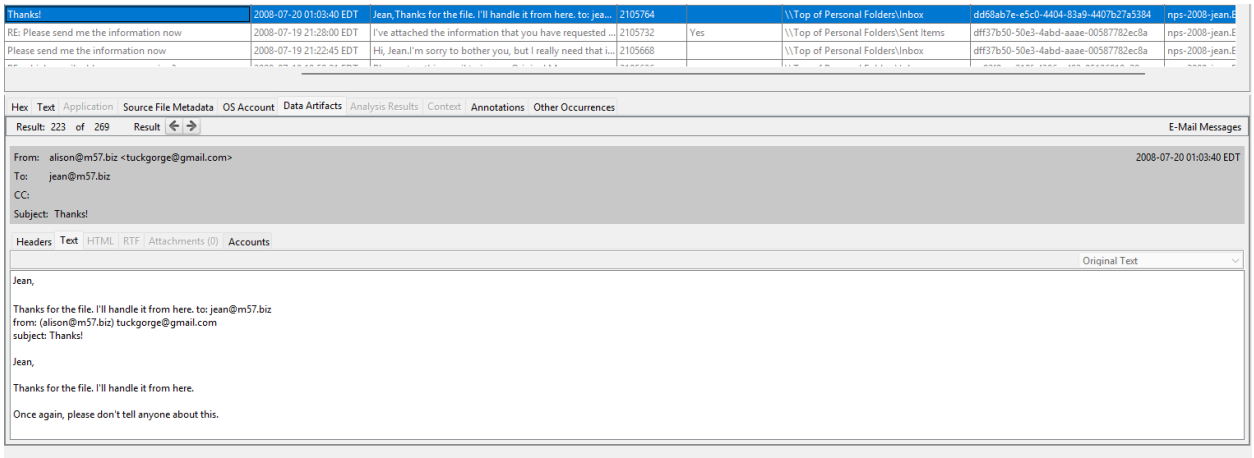
Content-Type: application/vnd.ms-excel
X-TIKA:Parsed-By: org.apache.tika.parser.DefaultParser
X-TIKA:Parsed-By-Full-Set: org.apache.tika.parser.DefaultParser
dc:creator: Alison Smith
dcterms:created: 2008-06-12T15:13:51Z
dcterms:modified: 2008-07-20T01:28:03Z
extended-properties:Application: Microsoft Excel
extended-properties:Company: M57.BIZ
extended-properties:TotalTime: 0
meta:last-author: Jean User

2. How did it get from Jean's computer to the competitor's website?

a. Jean was socially engineered. The only exfiltration path found on her drive is email, to an external Gmail account.
b. It was found under Data Artifacts > E- Mail Messages > Default ([Default]) > Default(261).
c. From there at 21:22 EDT, a second email arrived, "Please send me the information now". Its From header was tuckgorge@gmail.com (alison@m57.biz), so the display name said Alison but the real address was tuckgorge@gmail.com. It claimed an insistent VC needed the data.
d. At 21:27 EDT, Jean opened Excel and saved m57biz.xls.
e. At 21:28:00 EDT, Jean replied with the spreadsheet attached. The quoted header in her reply shows the recipient as tuckgorge@gmail.com.
f. At 01:03 EDT on 07-20, "Thanks!" came back from tuckgorge@gmail.com: "Thanks for the file. I'll handle it from here... please don't tell anyone about this."







3. Who else from the company is involved
    a. Besides from Jean and Alison, who were victims of this social engineering attack. tuckgorge@gmail.com is an external, unidentified party who impersonated Alison, received the file, and confirmed receipt.
    b. alex@m57 could be another participant, but not enough analysis from me to confirm that they were heavily involved in this attack.

4.